

Title

Non-Invasive Cardiac Imaging-Directed Management Versus Conventional Angiography-Based Care in Patients With Angina and Normal Coronary Arteries: Protocol for Evaluating Psychological and Symptom Outcomes

Abstract

Patients presenting with anginal chest pain but no obstructive coronary disease often experience persistent symptoms and psychological burden related to diagnostic uncertainty. This protocol describes a prospective, multicenter randomized trial comparing diagnostic and therapeutic approaches in this population. Approximately 250 participants with anginal symptoms undergoing invasive coronary angiography showing no significant stenosis will be randomized to one of two arms: (1) non-invasive stress cardiac imaging to classify disease subtype, with treatment targeted to identified physiologic abnormality, or (2) standard clinical management based on angiographic findings. Primary outcome is patient-reported illness perception measured at 6 and 12 months using validated scales. Secondary outcomes include psychological symptom severity, functional capacity, and symptom frequency. Baseline psychosocial assessments will be completed, and demographic and clinical factors will be evaluated as potential moderators. This study addresses a significant clinical gap by evaluating whether providing diagnostic clarity via advanced imaging improves psychological well-being.